

Squash “Thoup”

Note: This dish can also be made in a pressure cooker. See alternate cooking directions below.

Ingredients

- About 2 pounds zucchini (3 medium-sized)
- 2 medium-sized onions
- 1 pound Yukon gold potatoes (or other potato choice)
- 1 pound carrots
- 1 stalk celery
- 3 cans (14.5 ounces) diced tomatoes
- 5 large garlic cloves
- Olive oil
- 2 Tablespoons *Chicken Better-Than-Bouillon* base*
- $\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon dried oregano
- Salt and pepper

Note: Can substitute *Vegetable Better-Than-Bouillon* base.

Directions

Prep the vegetables:

- Rinse the zucchini, trim ends, slice lengthwise, then cut again into $\frac{1}{4}$ inch half-moons
- Peel and slice the onions
- Cut the potatoes into $\frac{1}{2}$ inch dice (if using mini-potatoes, cut in halves or quarters)
- Peel carrots and slice into $\frac{1}{4}$ inch coins
- Finely dice the celery
- Mince the garlic cloves

Coat the bottom of a large Dutch oven or heavy duty pot with 4 Tablespoons olive oil over medium-high heat. Add the sliced onions and celery and sauté for about 4 minutes.

Add in the minced garlic and sauté for another minute.

Season with salt and pepper, $\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon dried oregano, and 2 Tablespoons of the *Better-Than-Bouillon* base. Stir to combine.

Add in the diced tomatoes, zucchini, potatoes, and carrots. Season with additional salt and pepper and stir to combine.

Bring to a boil, then reduce to medium-low heat. Cover the pot. Simmer for 30 minutes.

Stir. Check seasoning and add salt and pepper to taste. Mash with a potato masher or immersion blender to begin to get the “thoup” consistency.

Cook uncovered for an additional 1 hour and 15 minutes or until the carrots and potatoes are fork tender.

Check seasoning. Add salt and pepper to taste if needed. Mash again to get to desired consistency (i.e., blended well with small discernable vegetable chunks – **not** a puree). Add some water if too thick.

Serve hot. Freezes well.

Alternate Cooking Method Using a Pressure Cooker

Follow cooking instructions up to the point of adding the tomatoes, zucchini, potatoes and carrots. Season with salt and pepper. Stir to combine.

Seal the pressure cooker cover and place the pressure regulator “cap” over the steam/vent valve. Start on medium-high heat.

Once vigorous steam begins to release through the vent and the pressure cooker float valve pops up (indicating “full pressure”), reduce the temperature to medium, and set a timer for 8 minutes.

Do not remove cover at this point.

Place the pressure cooker in the sink and run continuous cold water over it. When the float valve goes back down (you’ll hear a whoosh), it is safe to remove the cover.

Mash with a potato masher or immersion blender to get to desired consistency (i.e., blended well with small vegetable chunks – **not** a puree).